

c.500–323BCE

CLASSICAL GREECE

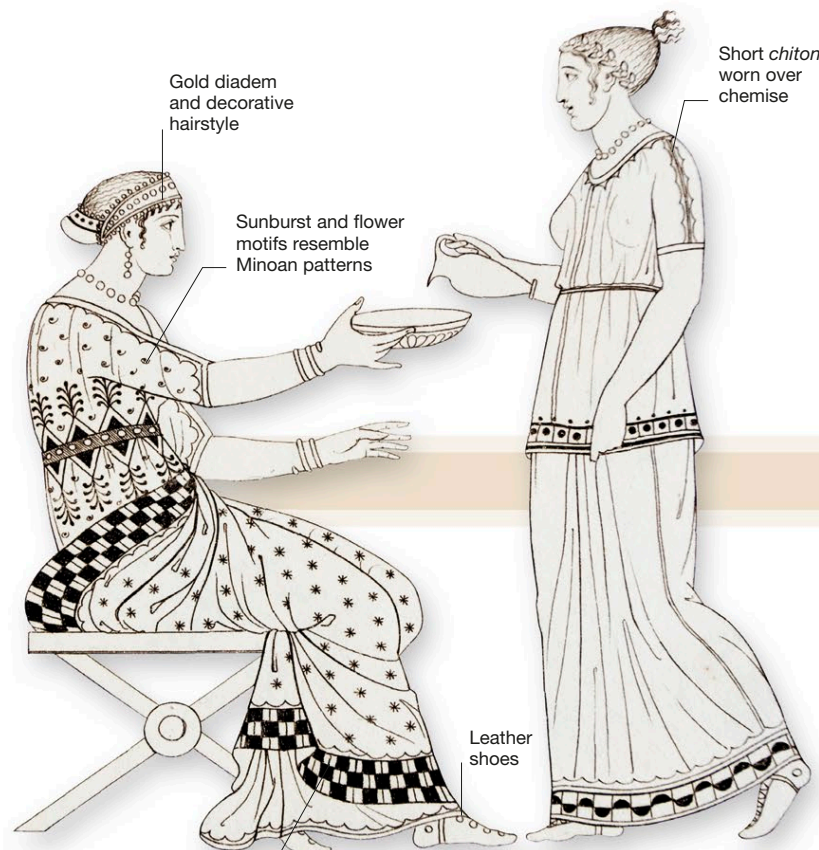
Clothing worn during the classical period of Ancient Greece was made of simple elements draped to sophisticated effect. Loose-fitting and free-flowing, it was adaptable to different seasons. The key garment for both men and women was the *chiton*, a tunic comprising two rectangles of cloth joined at the shoulders and sides. It could be arranged in many ways, and cut to different lengths. Worn over the *chiton* was a cloak-like garment, the *himation*; this was made of heavy material for outdoors, or of lighter cloth for a more fashionable effect indoors or in warmer weather. Women also wore an alternative version of the tunic, called a *peplos*, which was gathered in at the waist and partially fastened at the top of the shoulders, allowing the free corners to drape. The *chlamys*, a cape shaped like the clamshell it was named after, was originally worn by soldiers but, like many functional garments, became a fashion item.



Royal dress In a scene drawn from Greek legend, King Agamemnon abducts Princess Briseis during the Trojan War. The king wears a short *chiton*, which is covered by protective, armoured battledress, c.480BCE.



Decorative border Wealthy citizens hired musicians to entertain guests at banquets and festivities. A woman plays a flute in this 19th-century drawing. This classical profile is a prototype for figures in later European fashion.



Chiton Both these women from a 19th-century drawing by Thomas Hope wear a *chiton*. The figure on the left is clearly the wealthier of the two, with her more elaborate jewellery, decorative belt, and rich embroidery.



Charioteer's tunic This young driver has just won a race and makes a victory gesture, c.470BCE. He wears a type of long *chiton* known as a *xystis*, which was the usual dress for a charioteer at that time.